CRITEO | ChatGPT Ads

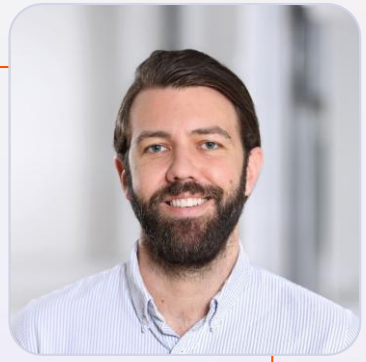
CRITEO WEBINAR

Holiday Shoppers are Starting with ChatGPT. Here's How Your Brand Can Be There.

OCTOBER 2026

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Today's Speakers



MICHAEL RASMUSSEN

SVP Product Marketing & GTM, Criteo

Covering

2026 Seasonal insights, and our ChatGPT Ads learnings.



STACEY BASSO

Marketing, OpenAI

Covering

What holiday shopping looks like on ChatGPT.



CAMILLE LEMERCIER

Senior Director, Account Strategy EMEA, Criteo

Covering

How to implement this Q4.

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SEASONAL INSIGHTS

01

Holiday 2026 Insights

Michael Rasmussen, Criteo

Stacey Basso, OpenAI

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The ramp to Holiday 2026 has started

57 days before purchase, when the slowest 25% of Black Friday buyers start researching (59 in EMEA).

17 days the average time from first product view to Black Friday purchase (18 in EMEA).

8.5 min the average time from first product view to Black Friday purchase for the fastest 25% of shoppers.

Source: Criteo Commerce Data. Time from first product-page or listing view to purchase, Black Friday weekend 2025. US; UK/FR/DE/ES/IT/PL.

50

days from today to Black Friday.

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SECTION 1 · THE 2026 SEASON

Cyber 6 is when new buyers show up

On Black Friday, first-time buyers make up a larger share of all buyers than on an ordinary October day.

The season rewards channels that bring you people you don't already have.



+261%

new-buyer acquisition on Black Friday, US, vs. early October.

+225%

new-buyer acquisition on Cyber Monday, US.

+189%

peak new-buyer acquisition, EMEA.

Source: Criteo Commerce Data. Indexed new-buyer acquisition vs. first four weeks of October 2025. New buyers are first-time buyers on a given retailer.
US; UK/FR/DE/ES/IT/PL.

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SECTION 1 · THE 2026 SEASON

Discovery happens across environments, and now in conversations with AI.

63%

of shoppers already use AI assistants for product research and discovery.

Source: Criteo Commerce Data, pre-purchase browsing, Nov 28–Dec 1 2025, US; UK/FR/DE/ES/IT. Criteo Global Shopper Survey, Feb 2026, n=6,379.



6

Average number of brands seen by a US shopper browsing across retailers

2

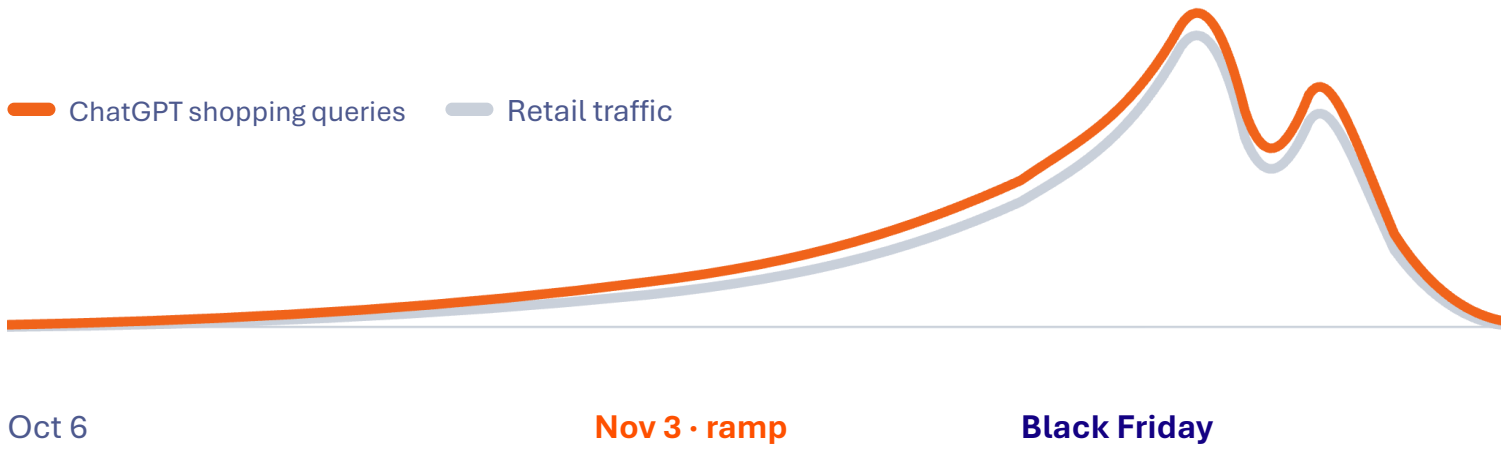
Average number of brands seen within a single retailer (3 vs. 2 in EMEA)

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SECTION 1 · CHATGPT'S ROLE

Holiday shopping on ChatGPT follows the same curve as retail

~1 billion people use ChatGPT across the shopping journey, and their activity ramps up as we head into the holidays.



+49%

ChatGPT shopping activity, Nov 3 – Dec 4, vs. preceding weeks

+94%

Black Friday peak vs. matched weekdays

Sources: ChatGPT internal data, US product-search activity 2025; Criteo Commerce Data, US 2025.

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The lift is largest in considered categories



CYBER 5

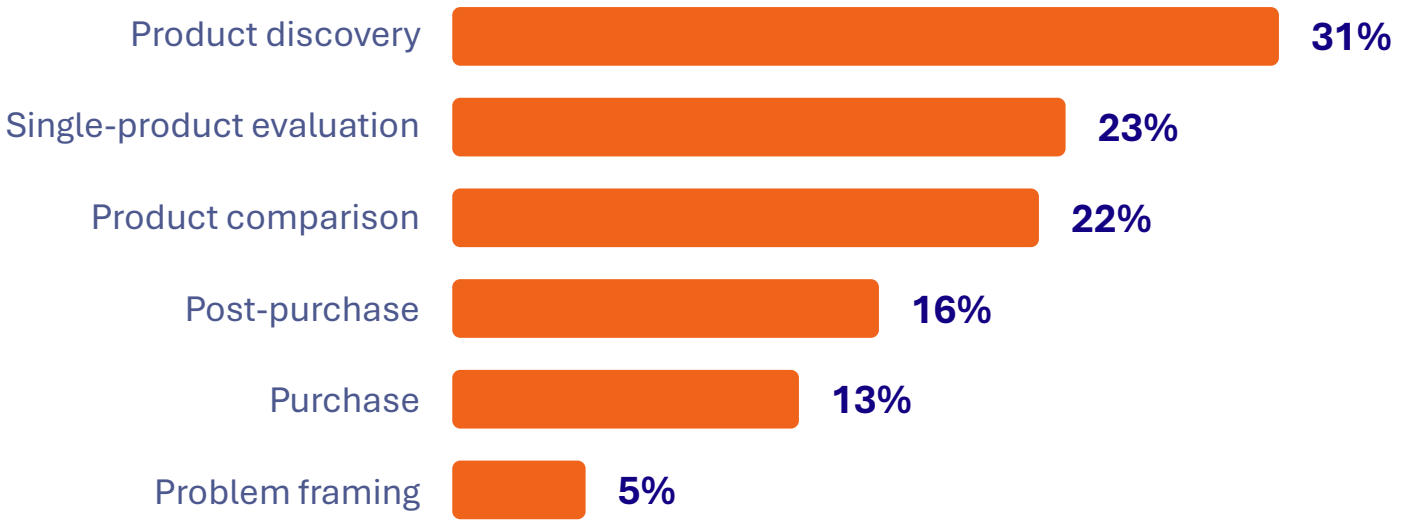
+94%

in Computer & Electronics and Appliances — the research-heavy categories lead.

Source: ChatGPT internal data, 2025, US. Holiday activity lift by category vs. preceding weeks.

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Most are past discovery when they arrive



AND WHEN THEY CLICK

70%

the percent of ChatGPT clicks that land directly on a product page, up from 50% a year ago.

Source: ChatGPT internal data, 2025, US. Holiday activity lift by category vs. preceding weeks.

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2026 is the first holiday where LLMs are a channel to plan for, not a trend to watch.



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ChatGPT Ads Insights

Michael Rasmussen, Criteo

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ChatGPT Ads is emerging as a channel that delivers new customers.

2,000+
live advertisers

60+
countries open

Source: Criteo, September 2026

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SECTION 2 · CHANNEL INSIGHTS

ChatGPT Ads brings you shoppers you don't already have

80%

of paid ChatGPT Ads traffic are new customers.

Source: Criteo ChatGPT Ads campaign data, 2026.

Incremental by design

Today, ChatGPT Ads reaches shoppers largely outside your existing audiences, so it brings in different users from what your current campaigns cover.

~0%

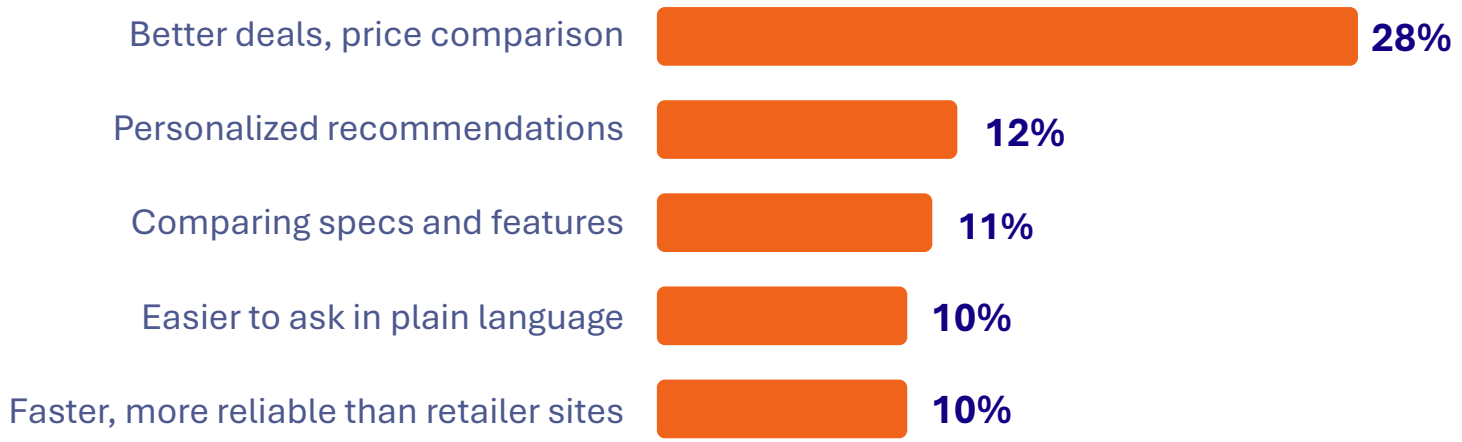
median sales-journey overlap with existing Criteo campaigns

8%

of ChatGPT landings are prior buyers

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Shoppers arrive from ChatGPT Ads with a decision to make...



Source: Criteo consumer survey — why shoppers use AI for shopping. Top five responses shown.

+ WHAT THIS MEANS

They're not asking ChatGPT what's out there.

They're asking which one is right for them, and whether the price is a good deal.

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SECTION 2 · CHANNEL INSIGHTS

...and they land where it gets made

Share of clicks landing on a product page



Source: Criteo PAX, AI Traffic Insights Q3 2026. US, June 2026, Chrome.

+ WHAT THIS MEANS

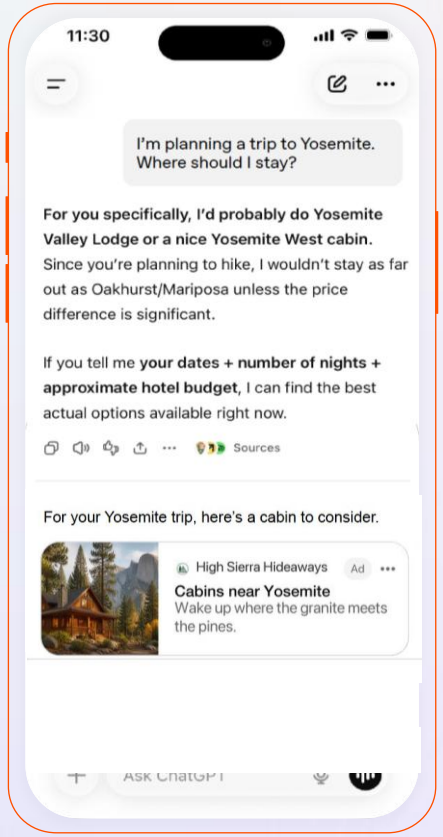
A good deal isn't the same as the lowest price. A click that lands on a specific product, often at a higher price point, is a different kind of click.

For the same advertiser, ChatGPT surfaces higher-priced products than Google search in most categories.

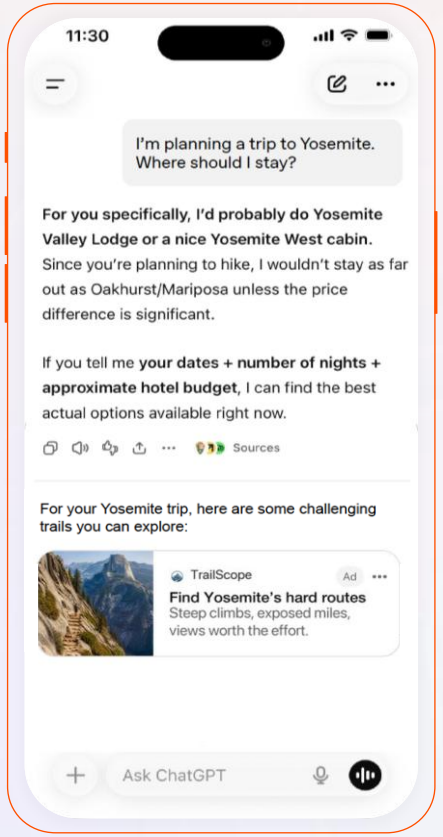
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SECTION 2 · CHANNEL INSIGHTS

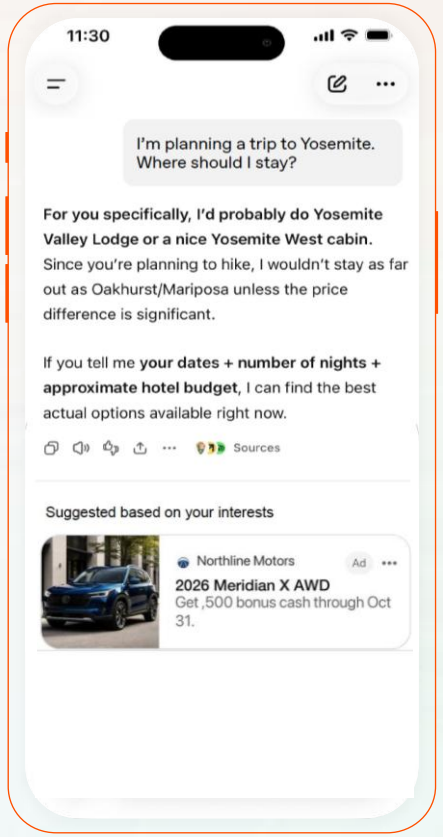
What your brand looks like within the prompt



Researching a holiday trip with friends.



Exploring challenging trails.



Researching a new car Purchase.

HIGH CONTEXTUAL RELEVANCE

HIGH PERSONAL RELEVANCE

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Personalization and automated creative differentiation drive results

Relevant to the person and the prompt

The prompt says what the shopper needs.

Your feed says what you have.

The richer and fresher the feed, the stronger the match.

01

One conversation, multiple messages

Prompt Smart generates hundreds to thousands of creative variations per product — up to 4x delivery vs. feed-based creative.

02

Context hints describe the conversation

Not a keyword, but a hint of where your ad may be relevant to the conversation: [product] + [use case] + [qualifier].

03

Sources: Criteo Prompt Smart results; Criteo ChatGPT Ads playbook.

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Measuring ChatGPT Ads performance, outside of ROAS



1. New customer reach

Holiday is a key window to reach new customers because consumers are shopping outside their typical habits (i.e. gifts for others).



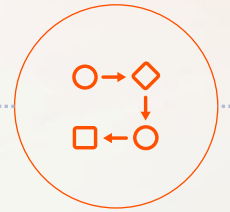
2. Delivery

Not just delivery overall, but delivery at the right moments, ensuring budgets can flex into Cyber 5.



3. Product & creative resonance

Holiday is a messaging game. When competition increases, creative personalization and resonance wins.



4. Path-to-purchase

Is the rest of your plan ready to pick up shoppers who don't convert same-session?

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ChatGPT Ads are incremental by design, reaching shoppers other channels can’t.

Synergy with the rest of your plan is where that incremental reach becomes revenue.



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HOW TO APPLY IT

03

The Q4 Plan

Camille Lemercier, Criteo

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The core tenets of winning Q4

Start early!

Shoppers research weeks, sometimes months, ahead. Waiting until Black Friday misses the window.



Use Cyber 6 to acquire

New-buyer acquisition surges in every market. Reach beyond the customers you already have.



Show up across environments

Shoppers who browse across retailers see three times more brands, compared to shoppers who browse within a single retailer.



Stay present

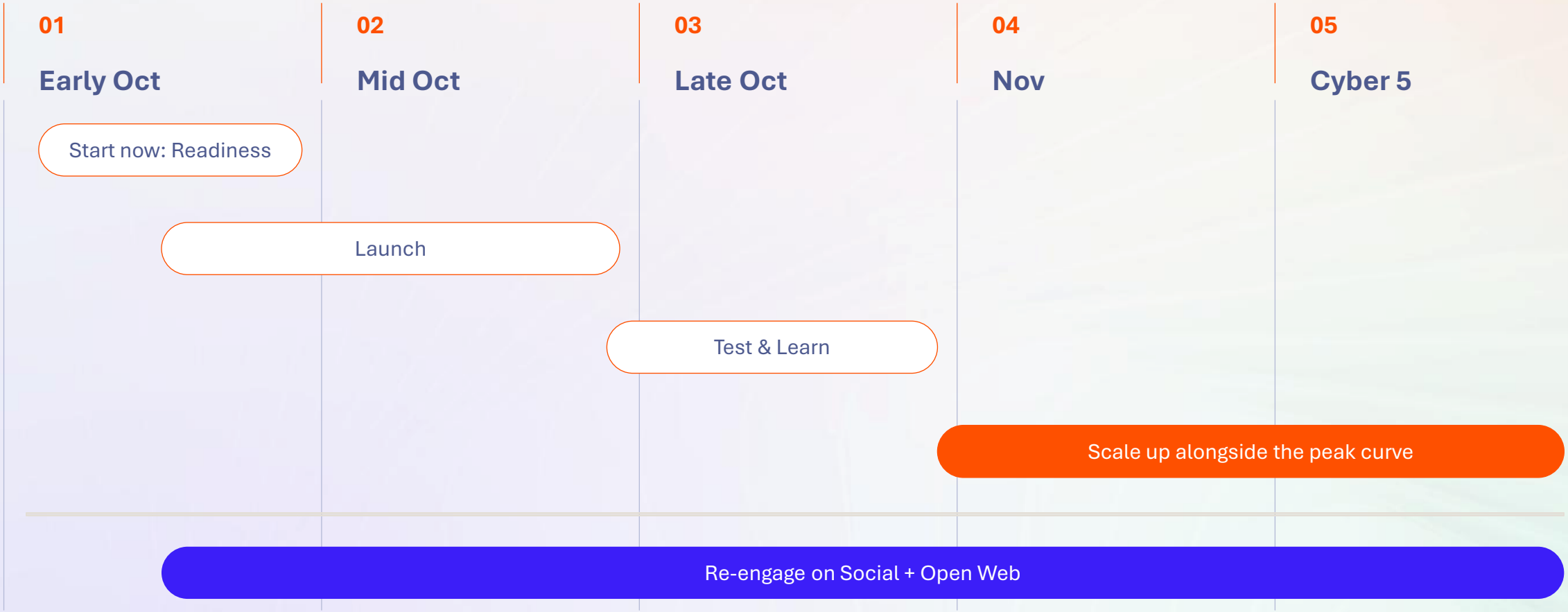
Multiple touches occur before conversion. Consistent visibility keeps you top of mind.



Source: Criteo Year-End Shopping Decoded, 'Where marketers can win'.

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The Q4 Plan for ChatGPT Ads



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Early October: get set up

Required

Branding Assets

Favicon and display name — how you appear next to your products.

Crawler Check

Robots.txt must let OpenAI's crawler read your product pages.

Highly Recommended

Feed Health

Ensure you have fresh, accurate product data, it's what gets matched to prompts.

OneTag or server-to-server live

It connects a ChatGPT click to what happens on site.

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Mid to late October: launch then learn

Mid October – Launch

- Hybrid campaign: no minimum, up to 70% of delivery to ChatGPT, budget shifts in flight.
- Utilize Prompt Smart from day one
- First context hints set around your top holiday use cases

01

Late October – Learn

- Product & creative resonance report: which products and messages are matching prompts
- Trim the product set to what's delivering
- Set the Nov 3 ramp budget against what you've learned

02

Source: Criteo ChatGPT Ads campaign options and insights reporting.

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SECTION 3 · THE Q4 PLAN

November: scale into the curve



October · baseline | Nov 3 · ramp | Cyber 5 · peak

A BUDGET PACING LADDER

THROUGH OCTOBER

1× Your learning budget. Set the baseline here.

NOV 3 – NOV 24

~1.5× Raise weekly budget by about half and hold.

CYBER 6

~2× Roughly double daily budget across the five days.

- From early Nov, scale up your program along the ramp curve observed in both retail data and ChatGPT shopper data.
- Scale up budget pacing along the curve, focusing on the gradual increase from early Nov through Cyber 5, and maximizing spend on the holidays themselves.

Source: ChatGPT internal data, US 2025. Activity ran ~49% above baseline across Nov 3 – Dec 4 and ~94% above on Black Friday.

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SECTION 3 · THE Q4 PLAN

ChatGPT Ads help find new users, your other channels help convert them.

Why it matters

80% of the shoppers ChatGPT Ads brings you are new customers.

~0% median overlap with your existing campaigns. These are shoppers your plan hasn't already messaged.

70% land on a product page, so the first visit tells you what they were looking for.

Sources: Criteo ChatGPT Ads campaign data 2026; Criteo PAX Q3 2026; Criteo audience targeting for ChatGPT visitors, Q4 2026.

How to do it

01 Tag your site
OneTag or server-to-server is strongly recommended.

02 Start in October
The earlier you launch, the more new shoppers you've met before the November ramp.

03 Plan for the follow-up
Make sure there's budget to re-engage these shoppers, not only to find them.

04 Pick up where they left off
New shoppers arrived interested in a specific product. Follow-up should start there, not at brand awareness.

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Someone *will* ask ChatGPT about your category this season. This is how your brand ends up in the answer.

- Reach out to your Criteo team to add ChatGPT Ads to current campaigns
- Submit your Q4 media plan for an assessment of where ChatGPT Ads fits

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Your Questions

Asked and answered by OpenAI & Criteo.

Stacey Basso · OpenAI **Michael Rasmussen** · Criteo **Camille Lemercier** · Criteo

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